坐火车去北京

奶奶一个人去看儿子

By Train to Beijing

Grandma goes to see her son on her own

Text and translation by Claude (Anthropic)

Footnotes mark names and words above HSK 1 (HSK 3.0 lists: github.com/ivankra/hsk30, MIT).

1 奶奶今年六十八岁，住在西安†。她的儿子在北京工作。奶奶很想他，想去北京看他。

2 儿子在电话里说：“妈，您一个人怎么来？”奶奶说：“我坐火车去。我一个人能去！”儿子说：“那您到了北京，先给我打电话，我再去火车站找您。”

买票

3 奶奶没有在网上买过票。她去问楼下的一个大学生。大学生说：“奶奶，您能用手机买票。我教您。”“先打开这个，再写‘西安’和‘北京’，再点这儿。”

4 “火车几点开？”奶奶问。“早上八点开，下午一点到北京。”奶奶在本子上都写了。她说：“我会了！”

† 西安 *Xī'ān* Xi'an (city)

Grandma is sixty-eight this year, and she lives in Xi'an. Her son works in Beijing. Grandma misses him a lot and wants to go to Beijing to see him. 1

Her son said on the phone, "Mum, how will you get here on your own?" Grandma said, "I'll go by train. I can go on my own!" Her son said, "Then when you get to Beijing, call me first, and I'll come to the station to find you." 2

Buying a Ticket

Grandma had never bought a ticket online. She went to ask a university student who lived downstairs. The student said, "Grandma, you can buy a ticket on your phone. I'll show you." "First open this, then type 'Xi'an' and 'Beijing', then tap here." 3

"What time does the train leave?" Grandma asked. "It leaves at eight in the morning and gets to Beijing at one in the afternoon." Grandma wrote it all down in her notebook. "Got it!" she said. 4

5 第二天早上，奶奶七点就到了火车站。火车站很大，人很多。奶奶不知道去哪儿。她问门口的一个人：“请问，去北京的火车在哪儿？”“您先去楼上，再找十号门。”

在火车上

6 八点，火车开了。奶奶旁边坐着一个小女孩儿和她的妈妈。女孩儿问：“奶奶，您去哪儿？”“我去北京看我儿子。”“您一个人去吗？您真行！”

7 女孩儿问：“到了北京，您怎么去您儿子家？”“我不知道。我儿子说他来火车站找我。”“您知道他家在哪儿吗？”奶奶打开本子：“在这儿。”

8 女孩儿拿了奶奶的手机，说：“您看，先打开地图，再写上这个地方。”

The next morning, Grandma was at the station by seven. The station was 5
big and crowded. Grandma didn't know where to go. She asked a man at the entrance, "Excuse me, where is the train to Beijing?" "Go upstairs first, then look for Gate Ten."

On the Train

At eight o'clock, the train pulled out. Beside Grandma sat a little girl and 6
her mother. The girl asked, "Grandma, where are you going?" "I'm going to Beijing to see my son." "You're going on your own? You're amazing!"

The girl asked, "When you get to Beijing, how will you get to your son's 7
home?" "I don't know. My son says he'll come to the station to find me." "Do you know where his home is?" Grandma opened her notebook. "It's here."

The girl took Grandma's phone and said, "Look. First open the map, then 8
type in this place."

8 “地图会告诉您怎么走。下了火车，您打车去，最好。”奶奶笑了：“谢谢你，小老师！”

到北京了

9 下午一点，火车到了北京。奶奶想：“儿子现在在工作，很忙。我先不给他打电话了。”她先打车，给开车的人看了手机上的地图。坐了半个小时，就到了。她再问楼下的一个老人：“请问，三号楼在哪儿？”“就在前边。”

10 晚上六点，儿子下班了。他想：“妈怎么还没有打电话？”他马上给妈妈打电话。“妈，您在哪儿？到北京了吗？我现在去火车站！”奶奶在电话里笑了：“别去火车站了。你回家吧。”

11 儿子回到家，看见妈妈坐在楼下，在和几个老人说话呢。“妈，您是怎么找到这儿的？”奶奶拿着手机笑了：“问人，也问手机！”

"The map will tell you which way to go. When you get off the train, it's best to take a taxi." Grandma smiled. "Thank you, little teacher!" 8

In Beijing

At one in the afternoon, the train arrived in Beijing. Grandma thought, "My son is at work now, and he's busy. I won't call him just yet." First she took a taxi and showed the driver the map on her phone. Half an hour later, she was there. Then she asked an old man downstairs, "Excuse me, where is Building Three?" "Just up ahead." 9

At six in the evening, her son finished work. He thought, "Why hasn't Mum called yet?" He phoned her at once. "Mum, where are you? Are you in Beijing? I'm going to the station right now!" Grandma laughed down the phone. "Don't go to the station. Just come home." 10

When her son got home, he saw his mother sitting downstairs, chatting with some old people. "Mum, how did you find this place?" Grandma held up her phone and laughed. "I asked people, and I asked my phone!" 11